manner. These subshells are designated as s, p, d, and f. Based on the arrangement of electrons in subshells, the elements of periodic table are classified into four blocks namely s, p, d and f blocks.

(1) s-Block Elements: It includes group 1 (alkali metals) and group 2 (alkaline earth metals) elements. They are also called as representative elements. The elements of group 1 (except hydrogen) are metals. They react with water to form solutions that change the colour of a litmus paper from red to blue. These solutions are said to be highly alkaline or basic. Hence they are called alkali metals.

The elements of group 2 are also metals. They combine with oxygen to form oxides, formerly called 'earths', and these oxides produce alkaline solutions when they are dissolved in water. Hence, these elements are called alkaline earth metals.

(2) p-Block Elements: These elements are in group 13 to 18 in the periodic table. They include boron, carbon, nitrogen, oxygen, fluorine families in addition to noble gases (Except helium). They are also called as representative elements. The p-block is home to the biggest variety of elements and is the only block that contains all three types of elements: metals, nonmetals, and metalloids.

(3) d-Block Elements: It includes group 3 to group 12 elements. They are found in the centre of the periodic table. Their properties are intermediate to that of s block and p block elements and so they are called transition elements.

(4) f – Block Elements: It includes 14 elements after (Lanthanum) La (57), called Lanthanoides and 14 elements after (Actinium) Ac (89), called Actinoides. They are placed at the bottom of the periodic table. They are also called as inner Transition elements.

12.2.4 Advantages of the Modern Periodic Table

- The table is based on a more fundamental property i.e., atomic number.
- It correlates the position of the element with its electronic configuration more clearly.
- The completion of each period is more logical. In a period, as the atomic number increases, the energy shells are gradually filled up until an inert gas configuration is reached.
- It is easy to remember and reproduce.
- Each group is an independent group and the idea of subgroups has been discarded.
- One position for all isotopes of an element is justified, since the isotopes have the same atomic number.
- The position of the eighth group (in Mendeleev's table) is also justified in this table. All transition elements have been brought in the middle as the properties of transition elements are intermediate between left portion and right portion elements of the periodic table.
- The table completely separates metals from nonmetals. The nonmetals are present in upper right corners of the periodic table.
- The positions of certain elements which were earlier misfit (interchanged) in the Mendeleev's periodic table are now justified because it is based on atomic number of the elements.
- Justification has been offered for placing lanthanides and actinides at the bottom of the periodic table.

12.2.5 Position of hydrogen in the periodic table

Hydrogen is the lightest, smallest and first element of the periodic table. Its electronic configuration ($1s^1$) is the simplest of all the elements. It occupies a unique position in the periodic table. It behaves like alkali metals as well as halogens in its properties.

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